

2026 RACE GUIDE

39 OPEN ENTRY RACES, NO QUALIFIER

19 in California, 20 across the US, all USATF certified. From summer 2026 through spring 2027, a window for whatever you're building toward. For the runner who lifts and the lifter who runs.

THE RULES OF THIS LIST

It's race season. If you've been waiting for the right moment to sign up for something, this is it. 39 open entry road races: 19 in California, 20 across the US. All USATF certified. All open to everyone, no matter how fast or slow you run.

The rule for everything in this guide: **no qualifying time, no lottery**. You register, you train, you show up. Races run from now through spring 2027, so there's a window for whatever you're building toward.

Prices go up as race day gets closer. A handful of these are sold out at standard entry, and the way in varies: some hold a waitlist, some run charity spots, some have neither. Each entry says which. Click through and verify before you register. Race capacity and pricing move fast.

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- 01 **Open entry:** no qualifying time required. Pay the fee and you're in.
 - 02 **USATF certified:** course distance is officially measured. PRs count.
 - 03 **Status flagged:** Open, Limited, or Sold Out, accurate as of September 2026.
 - 04 **Verify before you register:** capacity and pricing can shift between updates.
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19 CALIFORNIA RACES

OPEN ENTRY · SUMMER 2026 TO SPRING 2027

01 BEER CITY HALF, ALAMEDA

ALAMEDA, CA · JULY 10, 2027

[Check site](#)

www.alamedapint.com

Flat, fast, USATF certified Bay Area waterfront course. Good summer tune-up option. Craft beer at the finish. The 2026 race is done. Registration for the 2027 edition opens December 1, 2026.

5K · 10K · Half Marathon

● 2027 REGISTRATION OPENS DEC 1

02 THE SAN FRANCISCO MARATHON

SAN FRANCISCO, CA · JULY 24-25, 2027

[Check site](#)

www.thesfmarathon.com

Golden Gate Park, across the bridge, through the city. The 2026 race is run, 30,000 finishers across the weekend. Next one is the 50th anniversary edition and registration is already open.

5K · Half Marathon · Full Marathon

● 2027 REGISTRATION OPEN

03 NAPA TO SONOMA WINE COUNTRY HALF

NAPA, CA · JULY 18, 2027

[Check site](#)

www.runnapatosonoma.com

Point-to-point through active vineyards, Cuvaison Estate to Sonoma Plaza, with the Rosé 5K on the plaza the day before. The 2026 race is run. The 2027 waitlist is open now and gets you early access pricing plus registration 48 hours before everyone else.

Rosé 5K (Saturday) · Half Marathon (Sunday)

● 2027 WAITLIST OPEN

04 ~~SANTA ROSA MARATHON~~

~~SONOMA COUNTY, CA · AUG 22-23, 2026~~

Wine country roads, mostly flat, multi-distance weekend. The 2026 marathon, half and 10K sold out, while the Saturday 5K was the final distance available.

5K · 10K · Half Marathon · Full Marathon

● RACE IS PAST

05 ~~CALIFORNIAN DREAMIN' HALF MARATHON~~

~~LONG BEACH, CA · AUG 23, 2026~~

Flat out-and-back loops on the Long Beach beach path, starting and finishing on Ocean Blvd. Three distances, USATF certified, and the 5K and 10K both come in under \$60.

5K · 10K · Half Marathon

● RACE IS PAST

06 BEER CITY HALF, BISHOP RANCH

SAN RAMON, CA · SEP 12, 2026

East Bay edition. Multi-distance format with a 1-mile option. USATF certified. Good fall training block tune-up.

1 Mile · 5K · 10K · Half Marathon

● OPEN REGISTRATION

From \$32.80

[runsignup.com/Race/
CA/SanRamon/BeerCit
yBishopRanch](https://runsignup.com/Race/CA/SanRamon/BeerCityBishopRanch)

07 2XU LONG BEACH MARATHON

LONG BEACH, CA · OCT 10-11, 2026

One of SoCal's most consistent fall race weekends. City streets and coastline. Every 2026 distance is sold out — join the 2027 waitlist. October in Long Beach is as close to perfect race conditions as SoCal gets.

5K · Half Marathon · Full Marathon

● SOLD OUT · 2027 WAITLIST OPEN

Check site

[www.runlongbeach.co
m](https://www.runlongbeach.com)

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TWO CITIES MARATHON

FRESNO/CLOVIS, CA · NOV 1, 2026

Check site
www.run2cm.com

Central Valley fall classic. Multi-distance, USATF certified, point-to-point. Smaller field, less hype, faster moves through registration.

5K · 10K · Half Marathon · Full Marathon

● OPEN REGISTRATION

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SANTA BARBARA HALF MARATHON & 5K

SANTA BARBARA, CA · NOV 8, 2026

Check site
santabarbarahalf.com

Presented by HOKA. 13.1 along the waterfront plus a 5K and a kids fun run, finishing in the Funk Zone.

5K · Half Marathon

● OPEN REGISTRATION

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MONTEREY BAY HALF MARATHON

MONTEREY, CA · NOV 8, 2026

Waitlist only
www.montereybayhalfmarathon.org

Sold out in eight days, and the Race Benefactor entries went in fifteen minutes. One of the most beautiful half courses in California. The official waitlist is the only way in now.

Half Marathon

● SOLD OUT · WAITLIST ONLY

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BERKELEY HALF MARATHON

BERKELEY, CA · NOV 15, 2026

Check site
berkeleyhalfmarathon.com

USATF certified East Bay course winding through Berkeley campus, downtown, and the marina. Mid-November race day with full fall conditions.

Half Marathon

● OPEN REGISTRATION

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CALIFORNIA INTERNATIONAL MARATHON

SACRAMENTO, CA · DEC 6, 2026

Net downhill, point-to-point, USATF and World Athletics certified. One of the fastest marathon courses in the US. All standard tiers sold out at record speed. Gold Entry Draw closed in May.

Full Marathon

● **SOLD OUT · CHECK CHARITY OPTIONS**

\$230 (Gold)

runsra.org/california-international-marathon
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SAN DIEGO HOLIDAY HALF MARATHON & 5K

SAN DIEGO, CA · DEC 19, 2026

13.1 with a 711-foot net elevation drop along a rolling downhill bike path. A fast December half and a way to end the year with a PR attempt.

5K · Half Marathon

● **OPEN REGISTRATION**

Check site

www.sandiegoholidayhalf.com
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CARLSBAD MARATHON, HALF & 5K

CARLSBAD, CA · JAN 17-18, 2027

Coastal SoCal race down Carlsbad Boulevard with Pacific views for most of the course. Registration open early for the lowest pricing of the year.

5K · Half Marathon · Full Marathon

● **OPEN REGISTRATION**

Early bird pricing

inmotionevents.com/event/carlsbad-marathon
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SURF CITY MARATHON & HALF

HUNTINGTON BEACH, CA · FEB 2027

Pacific Coast Highway through Huntington Beach on Super Bowl Sunday. Coastal, fast, surfboard finisher medal. Annual; 2027 dates expected to be announced.

5K · Half Marathon · Full Marathon

● **2027 REGISTRATION**

Check site

www.runsurfcity.com

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LOS ANGELES MARATHON

LOS ANGELES, CA · MARCH 2027

Stadium to the Sea, Dodger Stadium to Santa Monica. One of the most iconic point-to-point marathon courses in the country. Open entry, no qualifier.

Full Marathon

● 2027 REGISTRATION

Check site

www.lamarathon.com
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MOUNTAINS 2 BEACH MARATHON & HALF

OJAI TO VENTURA, CA · APRIL 2027

Net downhill from Ojai to the Ventura coast. Known as one of the fastest BQ marathon courses in California. Annual; 2027 registration opens fall 2026.

Half Marathon · Full Marathon

● 2027 REGISTRATION

Check site

www.mountains2beachmarathon.com
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HOAG OC MARATHON RUNNING FESTIVAL

COSTA MESA, CA · MAY 2027

Annual SoCal weekend with marathon, half, 5K, and combo challenges. Course finishes at OC Fair & Event Center. Open entry, multi-distance.

5K · Half Marathon · Full Marathon

● 2027 REGISTRATION

Check site

ocmarathon.com
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ROCK 'N' ROLL SAN DIEGO

SAN DIEGO, CA · MAY 2027

Balboa Park start, finish in Little Italy, live music every mile. Annual SoCal classic. 2027 registration opens late 2026.

5K · Half Marathon · Full Marathon

● 2027 REGISTRATION

Check site

www.runrocknroll.com/events/san-diego
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20 US CERTIFIED RACES

NO QUALIFIER · ALL USATF CERTIFIED

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TUNNEL LIGHT MARATHON

NORTH BEND, WA · SEP 13, 2026

Net downhill point-to-point through the old Iron Horse rail tunnel and along the Snoqualmie Valley Trail. Boston qualifier, and the alternate course is listed as USATF certified. Cult favorite for PR attempts. Storm damage closed sections of the usual course, so 2026 runs an alternate permitted route. Registration closes September 6.

Half Marathon · Full Marathon

● OPEN · CLOSING SEP 6

From \$130.23

www.tunnelmarathon.com
- 02

LIFE TIME CHICAGO HALF MARATHON & 5K

CHICAGO, IL · SEP 27, 2026

Big-city feel without the lottery. The half marathon sold out, so the ways in now are the waitlist or one of the charity partners. The 5K and kids run are still open.

5K · Half Marathon

● 5K OPEN · HALF SOLD OUT

Check site

www.chicagohalfmarathon.com
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TWIN CITIES MARATHON

MINNEAPOLIS-ST. PAUL, MN · OCT 4, 2026

Consistently called the Most Beautiful Urban Marathon. Lakes, parks, fall foliage, city streets. Open entry, no lottery, no qualifier. Register and go.

10K · Half Marathon · Full Marathon

● OPEN REGISTRATION

Check site

www.tcmevents.org

04 HARTFORD MARATHON & HALF MARATHON

HARTFORD, CT · OCT 10, 2026

[Check site](#)

hartfordmarathon.com

Flat, fast, USATF certified. A popular Boston qualifier attempt course because the consistency is that good. Open registration, rarely sells out early.

Half Marathon · Full Marathon

● OPEN REGISTRATION

05 STEAMTOWN MARATHON

SCRANTON, PA · OCT 11, 2026

[Check site](#)

steamtownmarathon.com

Point-to-point, significant net downhill, USATF certified. Runners who are serious about a PR target Steamtown specifically for the course profile. Small field. Open entry.

Full Marathon

● OPEN REGISTRATION

06 BALTIMORE RUNNING FESTIVAL

BALTIMORE, MD · OCT 17, 2026

[Check site](#)

www.thebaltimoremarathon.com

26th annual event with a scenic harbor course. USATF certified, open entry, multi-distance. Bring a crew at different fitness levels.

5K · Half Marathon · Full Marathon

● OPEN REGISTRATION

07 ROCKET MORTGAGE DETROIT FREE PRESS

DETROIT, MI · OCT 18, 2026

[Check site](#)

www.freepmarathon.com

The international races cross the Ambassador Bridge into Windsor and return through the tunnel. The marathon and both half marathons are sold out; the 5K and 1 Mile remain open through Oct 8 unless capacity is reached.

5K · International Half · 1 Mile

● 5K & 1 MILE OPEN · MARATHON & HALVES SOLD OUT

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MARINE CORPS MARATHON

ARLINGTON, VA / WASHINGTON D.C. · OCT 25, 2026

No prize money. No elite wave. Just runners. The course goes past the Lincoln Memorial and through D.C. landmarks. General registration sold out. Charity spots open through July 31.

10K · Full Marathon

● **CHARITY SPOTS OPEN**

\$240 (Military \$225)

www.marinemarathon.com/event/marine-corps-marathon
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CNO FINANCIAL INDIANAPOLIS MONUMENTAL

INDIANAPOLIS, IN · NOV 7, 2026

Flat, fast, USATF certified. Open registration, no lottery, no qualifier. One of the most runner-friendly big-city race setups in the country.

5K · Half Marathon · Full Marathon

● **OPEN REGISTRATION**

Check site

monumentalmarathon.com
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SAVANNAH SOUTHERN HALF MARATHON & 5K

SAVANNAH, GA · NOV 14, 2026

13.1 through Savannah's historic squares, oak-lined streets, and a finish through Savannah Bananas' Grayson Stadium. Promo code available for \$10 off.

5K · Half Marathon

● **OPEN REGISTRATION**

Check site

www.southernhalf.com
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ALLIANZ RICHMOND MARATHON

RICHMOND, VA · NOV 14, 2026

Called America's Friendliest Marathon. USATF sanctioned, certified, and a top Boston qualifier course. Full marathon sold out at the fastest pace in event history. Half marathon and 8K still open, waitlist for the full.

8K · Half Marathon · Full Marathon

● **HALF & 8K OPEN · FULL SOLD OUT**

Check site

www.richmondmarathon.org

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PHILADELPHIA MARATHON WEEKEND

PHILADELPHIA, PA · NOV 20-22, 2026

Full marathon sold out. Half marathon and 8K still open. Certified course through historic Philly. No qualifier for remaining distances.

8K · Half Marathon

● HALF & 8K OPEN · FULL SOLD OUT

Check site

www.philadelphiamarathon.com

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WILLIAMS ROUTE 66 MARATHON

TULSA, OK · NOV 21-22, 2026

Full weekend on the Mother Road's 100th birthday: marathon, half, relay, and 5K through downtown Tulsa. Certified course, open entry, and a finish-line party that earns its reputation.

5K · Relay · Half Marathon · Full Marathon

● OPEN REGISTRATION

Check site

www.route66marathon.com

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SPACE COAST MARATHON & HALF

COCOA, FL · NOV 22, 2026

Florida's oldest marathon, 55 years running. Space-themed race day along the Indian River from historic Cocoa Village with a riverfront finish. Full marathon sold out early, the earliest in event history. Half marathon still open but selling fast.

Half Marathon · Full Marathon

● HALF OPEN · FULL SOLD OUT

Check site

www.spacecoastmarathon.com

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BMW DALLAS MARATHON FESTIVAL

DALLAS, TX · DEC 11-13, 2026

55th year. New dynamic pricing model so the earlier you register the less you pay. Multi-distance fall race weekend in downtown Dallas.

5K · 10K · Half Marathon · Full Marathon

● OPEN REGISTRATION

Dynamic pricing

dallasmarathon.com

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JAL HONOLULU MARATHON

HONOLULU, HI • DEC 13, 2026

No qualifier, no cutoff time, ages 7 and up. The course runs from Ala Moana through Waikiki, around Diamond Head, and back. Bucket-list December marathon.

Merrie Mile • 10K • Full Marathon

● OPEN REGISTRATION

[Check site](#)
www.honolulumarathon.org
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CHEVRON HOUSTON MARATHON WEEKEND

HOUSTON, TX • JAN 15-17, 2027

Aramco Houston Half on Sunday Jan 17. Flat, fast, USATF certified. Registration runs Nov 1, 2026 through early January.

5K • Half Marathon • Full Marathon

● 2027 REGISTRATION

[Check site](#)
www.chevronhoustonmarathon.com
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CHERRY BLOSSOM TEN MILE

WASHINGTON D.C. • APRIL 2027

Tidal Basin, cherry trees in peak bloom, ten flat miles. Annual lottery for general entry; charity bibs available. USATF certified.

5K • 10 Mile

● LOTTERY + CHARITY ENTRIES

[Check site](#)
www.cherryblossom.org
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CRESCENT CITY CLASSIC 10K

NEW ORLEANS, LA • APRIL 2027

One of the oldest 10Ks in the country. Course goes through downtown New Orleans, the French Quarter, and Esplanade Ave. USATF certified. 2027 registration open.

10K

● 2027 REGISTRATION OPEN

\$55 to \$80

ccc10k.com

NYCRUNS BROOKLYN SPRING HALF

BROOKLYN, NY · APRIL 25, 2027

Check site

brooklynexperience.
com

Prospect Park loop course. NYCRUNS runs a clean operation: easy bib pickup, USATF certified, no lottery. The Brooklyn half marathon without the Brooklyn half wait list.

5K · Half Marathon

● 2027 REGISTRATION

**RUN. LIFT.
SWEAT.**

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UPDATED SEPTEMBER 2026